

PM Planning with Adam (01/26/2026)

News for Today

- Durable Goods Orders (MoM) (Nov) Actual (5.3%) Forecast (3.1%) Previous (-2.1%) (8:30AM)
- 2-Year Note Auction Previous (3.499%) (1:00PM)
- Allied Gold (\$AAUC)  3% — Zijin Gold International to acquire the company in an all-cash C\$5.5B deal.
- USA Rare Earth (\$USAR)  22% — Trump administration reportedly taking a 10% stake as part of a \$1.6B debt-and-equity package.
- Newmont (\$NEM)  (strong gains) & Barrick Mining (\$B)  — gold miners rally as bullion hits a record \$5,100/oz, driven by safe-haven flows.
- Baker Hughes (\$BKR)  2.2% — Q4 adjusted profit rose 11%, powered by strength in gas technology equipment & services.
- Meta Platforms (\$META)  0.6% — Redburn upgrades to Buy, citing unmatched demand-matching capability and major AI monetization potential.
- Leidos (\$LDOS)  0.7% — acquiring ENTRUST Solutions Group for \$2.4B to expand utility engineering offerings.
- Skywater Technology (\$SKYT)  7.7% — IonQ to acquire the company for \$35/share, valuing the deal at \$1.8B.
- American Airlines (\$AAL), Delta (\$DAL), United Airlines (\$UAL)  1%+ — winter storms threaten flight delays & cancellations nationwide.
- Revolution Medicines (\$RVMD)  21% — Merck ends acquisition talks, per WSJ report.

 Market Overview — Monday, January 26, 2026 U.S. Futures Slip as Markets Brace for Fed Decision and Big Tech Earnings

U.S. stock index futures edged modestly lower Monday, with investors stepping cautiously into a pivotal week packed with a Federal Reserve meeting, heavyweight tech earnings, and simmering geopolitical risks.

At 05:35 ET, Dow futures dipped 15 pts (-0.1%), S&P 500 futures eased 8 pts (-0.1%), and Nasdaq 100 futures fell 65 pts (-0.3%).

The declines follow a second straight losing week on Wall Street, as geopolitical tensions kept risk appetite subdued and pushed investors toward safety trades.

 Fed Meeting Takes Center Stage

The week's main storyline is the Federal Reserve's two-day policy meeting, set to conclude Wednesday. Markets overwhelmingly expect no rate change, following three consecutive cuts late last year.

Analysts say the Fed is likely transitioning into a multi-month pause:

- ABN Amro noted the Fed will "start an extended pause"
- The bank now forecasts no move until June
- Recent growth data and a stabilizing unemployment rate have given policymakers room to hold steady

Meanwhile, Trump's public feud with Fed Chair Jerome Powell remains a flashpoint. Powell revealed the DOJ had opened a criminal probe into him — a move he labeled political. With Powell's term ending in May, Trump is expected to announce his replacement soon, heightening concerns about the Fed's independence.

Big Tech Earnings on Deck

Roughly 20% of the S&P 500 reports this week, including four of the Magnificent Seven, setting the tone for the broader market.

Here's the key lineup:

- Tesla → Wednesday
- Microsoft → Wednesday
- Meta Platforms → Wednesday
- Apple → Thursday

Investors will be watching for:

- Consumer demand trends
- AI monetization progress
- Margin resilience amid higher costs
- How execs talk about geopolitics and tariffs

Given the market's heavy reliance on megacap tech leadership, these reports could swing indices sharply.

Gold Smashes Through \$5,100/oz as Geopolitical Stress Builds

Safe-haven demand continued to roar, with gold surging above \$5,100/oz for the first time ever, extending last week's blistering rally.

A series of geopolitical flashpoints are fueling the run:

- Trump warned he may slap 100% tariffs on Canada if Ottawa signs a trade deal with China
- Canada responded firmly, saying it has "no intention" of pursuing such a deal
- The U.S. recently secured control over Greenland, adding another layer of global tension
- Concerns rising over potential U.S. military escalation with Iran



The combination has left global markets on edge and pushed traders deeper into havens.

Oil Extends Gains on Iran Tensions & Winter Storms

Oil prices ticked up again Monday, building on last week's strength.

- Brent: \$65.21 (+0.2%)
- WTI: \$61.18 (+0.2%)

Both benchmarks climbed 2.7% last week, closing at their highest levels since Jan. 14.

Drivers behind today's move:

- Trump warned the U.S. has an "armada" moving toward Iran
- A U.S. carrier strike group is expected to arrive in the region within days
- Winter storms across the U.S. cut crude & natural gas production
- Power prices spiked as freezing conditions spread across the country

Together, these factors supported the broader energy complex.

Adam's Watchlist

- \$QQQ: Looking to go long off the 623.30's KL for a push up into the 625's KL and potentially the 627's KL. If we break below, I'll be going short off the 621's KL for a push down into the 618.44's KL and potentially the 615.13's KL.
- \$CRWV: Looking to go long off the 100's KL for a push up into the 104's KL and potentially the 109.60's KL.
- \$NVDA: Looking to go long off the 187.16's KL for a push up into the 190's KL.

- \$META: Looking to go long off the 668.16's KL for a push up into the 681's KL.
 - \$MSTR: Looking to go long off the 160.37's KL for a push up into the 165's KL.
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⚡ COMMUNITY WATCHLIST ⚡

- \$MP: Looking to go long off the 74.50's KL for a push up into the 79's KL.
 - \$USAR: Looking to go long off the 31.20's KL for a push up into the 34's KL and potentially the 37.50's KL.
 - \$NFLX: Looking to go long off the 87's KL for a push up into the 88.50's KL and potentially the 90's KL.
 - \$IREN: Looking to go long off the 58.30's KL for a push up into the 63's KL.
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